Strategy audit — the playbook as an executable plan

Audit date: 2026-10-24. **Auditor scope:** plan coherence, ordering, dependencies, contradictions, realism, decision rules, compute usage, first-timer gaps. Claim-level source verification is a separate review (`source-audit`); this file only checks whether the *plan* holds together and can be executed by one person with 4×A100 40 GB plus Kaggle free GPUs by **2026-12-02 23:59 UTC**.

Inputs read: `README.md`, `docs/00–07`, `docs/SOURCES.md`, and the local `harness_readme_raw.md` / `getting_started_notebook.txt` where a doc claim needed a tie-break.

Severity scale

Level	Meaning
P0	Can lose a submission, or makes the plan's own critical path impossible. Fix before anything else.
P1	Burns a week or a submission slot; decision rule is statistically or operationally wrong.
P2	Real inefficiency or missing dependency; costs days, not the competition.
P3	Polish/consistency; fix in a final pass.

1. Verdicts on the seven questions

1. **Order — mostly right, wrong at both ends.** Prompt-only → calibrated eval → trajectories → LoRA → adapter validation → selection is the correct dependency chain. But the plan puts local infrastructure *before* the first submission (README §4 Path A, `04` §3–§4) when the public 0.24 zip needs no infrastructure and can be scored on day 1. And it ends without a freeze date or a defined selection procedure. Two dependencies are missing entirely: per-task setup time in the 12 h projection (F03) and a hardware derating from A100 to 4×L4 (F22).
2. **Missing steps/blockers.** No Docker sandbox build (F07), no wheelhouse pinning for adapter validation (F21), no HF gated-model access or rules acceptance (F25), no failure-taxonomy pass before training (F28), no trajectory-generation cost estimate (F27), no prompt freeze across train/eval (F17).
3. **Contradictions.** Six that matter: 8-min vs 5–6-min cap (F02); 4 096-token training vs 7k–17k-token trajectories (F05); trajectory counts that cannot exist (F04); alpha sweep that includes a documented-degenerate scale (F10); graph tools declared-but-discouraged while the doc says remove them (F18); `timeout_seconds` claimed to affect Phase-2 pytest when it does not (F09). Plus the paper "parallel, non-conflicting" claim (F14).
4. **Six-week plan — not realistic as written.** It is 42 days against 39 available, and the paper (Nov 12) and entry (Nov 25) deadlines land inside weeks 3 and 5 with no calendar mapping (F01). Week 4 bundles first adapter + rank/alpha sweeps + paired eval + submission, which is roughly double the capacity once the 14–33 h queue is counted. Cut list in §3.
5. **Stop criteria — directional, not actionable.** `03` §12 has one gate that always fires (F04), one unquantified ("threatens the 12 h limit"), and no dates or infra gate (F15). `06` §3.4's "≥2-task win" is inside noise at typical discordant counts (F13).
6. **Overpromise vs underuse — both.** Prose correctly says post-training is optional, but the calendar makes it the critical path and gives the two highest-EV levers (budget fit, a second diverse submission) one week each. Meanwhile the 4×A100 is treated as four independent single-GPU boxes: no serving allocation (F11), no seed replication for the noise floor, no role for the extra GPUs during evaluation, no distillation plan despite rules allowing it. Kaggle GPUs are named as a resource and never assigned a job (F23).
7. **First-timer gaps.** Rules acceptance/joining and the entry deadline have no checklist step (F25); final-selection mechanics are only half described (F16); licensing inventory is missing (F24);

`submission.parquet` is unexplained (F19); the sample submission ships dummy adapters that get registered by the scorer (F20).

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2. Prioritized findings

ID	Sev	Doc / section	Issue	Why it matters	Concrete change
F01	**P0**	README §5; `00` §2	"Six-week execution plan" starting 2026-10-24 ends 2026-12-05; the final deadline is 2026-12-02. Paper deadline (Nov 12) sits inside week 3, entry/merger deadline (Nov 25) inside week 5. Nothing maps dates to weeks.	The plan is 3 days longer than the competition. Week 6 ("final selection, do not submit on the last day") collapses to 1–2 days, and the paper week silently collides with trajectory generation.	Replace week numbe dated calendar: W1 O W2 Oct 31–Nov 6, W3 W4 Nov 14–20, W5 N **freeze Nov 28**, final s 29–Dec 1. Put "paper on Nov 10 and "entry on Nov 24 as hard gat
F02	**P0**	`02` §2.1, §3.1; `05` R1	The recommended primary bundle is the public 0.24 config at `max_time_minutes: 8`, while `05` R1 recommends 5–6 min and `02` §3.1 shows 8 min × 120 tasks = 16 h. S34's own measurement of that config is 5.4 min mean, i.e. 10.8 h of agent time.	The 8-min cap is a per-task ceiling, not a mean, and the mean is already at 90% of the global budget. Any change that adds time (adapter, more thinking, extra verification) converts a scored run into "Notebook Timeout, no partial score" (S29).	Make **5 min / 24 calls thinking 2048** the prim and 8 min an A/B expe Gate: projected `120 setup) ≤ 9.5 h`. K min zip only as the kn fallback.
F03	**P0**	`02` §3.1; `05` R1	The projection model includes `T_setup,i` but no document ever measures or estimates it, even though S1 says the 12 h includes sandbox setup and the harness explicitly excludes setup from the agent timer (S5:511).	This is the exact mechanism behind the 22 Oct timeout (S29). At 5.4 min agent + 1 min setup, 120 tasks = 12.8 h — over budget with a config everyone calls safe.	Add a measured `setu` column to `task_resu` the aggregate schema Project `120 × (ager setup_p50)`. Publish in `05` R1 as the gate, formula.
F04	**P0**	`03` §4.1, §4.6, §12	Units are muddled. §4.1 keeps "the shortest successful trajectory" per task (≤129 total from 129 public tasks); §4.6 asks for "300–1,000 resolved trajectories" *and* "500–2,000 per-call samples"; §12 stops the line below "~300 high-quality resolved trajectories". S25's "697 examples from 99 tasks" are per-call samples, not trajectories.	Following §4.1 literally yields ≤129 trajectories, so the §12 stop gate fires automatically and kills the LoRA line by design. The compute estimate is also off by ~5× depending on which unit you believe.	Define once: **task** (12 **trajectory** (one resolv keep top-k per task, e 500 from 4 temps), **sa** assistant turn, ~7–15 trajectory; expect 900- Gate on tasks ≥80 **an** ≥700; delete the 300-t gate.
F05	**P0**	`03` §6.2 vs `03` §4.3, §13	Single-GPU QLoRA is scheduled at `sequence_len: 4096` with "try 8192". S40 reports agent trajectories at 7k–17k tokens; the doc's own checklist forbids "mid-tool-call truncation".	Training at 4 k silently truncates most samples mid-turn, teaching truncated tool calls — the exact failure mode the prompt fights. The recommended recipe may be unusable with the recommended data format.	Measure the token-len distribution of the first before choosing. Requ sequence length or tru at turn boundaries (ke last observation + com p95 > 8 k, go straight BF16 at 16 k or drop
F06	**P0**	README §4 Path A; `04` §3–§4	Order puts serving + local smoke test + calibration before the first submission. The public 0.24 bundle needs none of that: it is a zip (S36 packages without inference).	The first scored run is the only real measurement of the pipeline, and it is free of infrastructure risk. Delaying it by 3–7 days means the first hidden signal arrives after	Reorder: **Day 1** submi unmodified public 0.24 probe. **Day 2–7** build stack in parallel. Neve infrastructure gate the run.

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				week 1, and a broken submission mechanism is discovered late.	
F07	**P1**	`04` §3.2, §4.1; `01` §5.1	`--sandbox docker` assumes `swebench-sandbox:latest` exists. The harness README names the image but gives no build command; the competition ships `docker/` build files (`00` §4) and the runbook never uses them.	On a fresh 4×A100 box the first `swegemma eval` fails with a missing image, and the runbook has no recovery path. This blocks week 2 entirely.	Add an explicit step: b `swebench-sandbox` from the competition `d` directory, then run a 1- test as the exit criterio the image digest in the
F08	**P1**	`04` §4.1; `05` R2	Calibration is framed as reproducing 127/129 gold patches, a multi-day rebuild (S31/S32), inside a one-week slot that also contains prompt sweeps.	127/129 is a research artifact, not a requirement. Chasing it consumes the week that should produce the second submission and the first prompt experiment.	Gate on **10–15 tasks four repos** (≥2 fastap with ≥90% gold pass a patch resolves. Mark t "uncalibrated" and nev on them.
F09	**P1**	`02` §2.1 vs `01` §8.1	`02` says the 240 s command timeout "is also used by the scoring pytest run". `01`'s own table (from S5:506) says the Phase-2 verification timeout is fixed at 300 s and is not configurable via `eval_config.yaml`.	A reader may shorten or lengthen `evaluation.timeout_seconds` expecting it to affect test scoring, or believe 240 s is a scorer guarantee. It only affects Phase-1 tool commands.	Correct `02` §2.1: `evaluation.timeo` maps to `command_timeout_` (Phase 1) only; Phase 300 s on the scorer. K agent commands and (S38's rationale), not a guarantee.
F10	**P1**	README §4 Path B; `03` §9.4	"Rank 8–16, alpha = rank" combined with "sweep alpha 8/16/32 at inference". At rank 8 that sweep is scale 1.0 / 2.0 / 4.0 — and scale 2.0 is the documented degenerate point (S25).	One third of the planned sweep is a known-bad configuration, and the sweep confounds rank with scale. Wasted restarts and a wasted paired eval.	Pin **rank 16** for the alp and sweep **scale** {0.5 (alpha 8/16). Add 2.0 s diagnostic if both fail. test rank 8, use alpha
F11	**P1**	README §4 Path B; `03` §6.2–6.3	No GPU allocation. Serving the 31B needs TP=2–4 (S34 served it on one A100); training needs 1–4 GPUs; the alpha sweep needs serving *while* training artifacts exist. "Use the other three A100s for parallel configs/seeds" leaves no GPU for the evaluator.	You cannot run the week-4 loop (train → export → serve → paired eval → next sweep) without a written allocation. This is the most likely source of a lost week.	Add an allocation table **eval/serving** = GPU 0 W4A16, TP=1, 32 k) o (TP=2); **training** = GP (parallel single-GPU C four (FSDP2, serving State explicitly which p exclusive.
F12	**P1**	`06` §2.2	Dev, Holdout A and Holdout B are all stratified *within* the same four repos, so every split shares repositories with every other split. The doc simultaneously warns that hidden tasks are private repos (S2/S31).	A local win on a repo the adapter was trained on says nothing about private-repo transfer — the core measurement problem the docs identify. This inflates confidence exactly where it matters.	Make **Holdout B a lea repo-out set** (rich, 48 requests, 13) never se dev/training; keep Hol stratified. Report both separately.
F13	**P1**	`06` §3.4; `03` §9.5	Promotion rule is "wins ≥2 more tasks on 20–40 paired tasks". Exact sign test: 2 wins out of 6 discordant pairs gives p≈0.69; out of 8, p≈0.29; out of 10, p≈0.11. At ~120 hidden tasks, 2 tasks = 0.017 — below the 0.01 display resolution.	The rule promotes noise. Combined with a 14–33 h queue, one noisy promotion can consume the only remaining slot before the freeze.	Require **≥8 discordan ≥75% wins** (or two se p95/patch-rate regress hidden score before th eligible for a final slot. discordant counts, not
F14	**P1**	`07` §1.6; README	Paper deadline is Nov 12 (19 days out); the suggested angles 2–3 depend on trajectory/LoRA results that do not exist	As written the paper is either unwritable or forces the training	Re-scope now to evid exists by Nov 1: budge global timeout, evalua

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		§4 Path D	until week 4 (Nov 14–20). 07 §1.6 says "collect data/results" by Nov 1, when the only results available are the baseline and prompt sweeps. README calls the paper "parallel, non-conflicting".	line to start a week early, which breaks the calibration dependency.	local-to-hidden transfe tool utility. Decide by **N** or no paper. If yes, cap working days and drop case study.
F15	**P1**	03 §12; 05 §5	Stop criteria have no dates, one gate that always fires (F04), and one unquantified gate ("increases mean time enough to threaten the 12 h limit"). There is no infra stop and no overall project kill criterion.	Stop criteria that cannot be evaluated on a calendar date do not stop anything; the team keeps training while slots expire.	Rewrite as dated gate calibration ≥90% or fa known-good sandbox; adapter must pass A/B discordant-pair win or line closes; **Nov 20** ac have a hidden score; l new experiments; **Nov** Add "project kill": if bes <0.12 by Nov 25, stop and spend the last slo prompt/budget variant
F16	**P1**	07 §2.3; 04 §10.4	"It consumes one of your two final slots" conflates *submitting* an E4B run with *selecting* it. A scored E4B run costs one daily submission, not a final slot; only selection costs a slot. Final-selection mechanics (how to select, only scored submissions are selectable) are also only half described.	The framing makes the cheapest hedge in the plan (one E4B probe on an idle GPU) look expensive, so it never gets measured, and the Dec 1 decision is made blind.	Say explicitly: a probe daily slot and zero fina one E4B prompt-only week 2. Decide select from scores. Add a "se step to the runbook wi screenshot/confirmatio rule that both selection already be scored.
F17	**P2**	03 §4.2, §4.3; 06 §4	Thinking mode must match, but the **prompt and tool schema** are never frozen across trajectory generation, adapter eval and submission. 06 records `prompt_sha256` but no rule uses it.	An adapter trained on the 0.24 prompt is evaluated against a tuned prompt; any gain or loss is uninterpretable, and the final bundle may differ from both.	Add a rule: one `promp` + `tool_schema_sha` whole adapter line. If t changes after generat regenerate a 30-task c slice or drop the adapt
F18	**P2**	02 §2.1 vs §5.6; README §7	The 0.24 config declares all nine tools but the prompt forbids three; 02 §5.6 says "if not useful, remove them from `tools` so the prompt doesn't advertise them". The harness filters guidance to declared tools (S5:282).	Declaring-then-forbidding costs prompt tokens and adds a rule the model must obey instead of a capability it lacks. It also leaves the reader with two contradictory instructions.	Pick one default (remo graph tools) and run E 15 tasks to justify it. D decision in 02 §2.1 rat both.
F19	**P2**	00 §4; 01 §2.1	`submission.parquet` is listed as provided data, but the runbook only uploads `submission.zip`. Nothing explains that the scorer's `scripts/inference.py` produces the parquet (`harness_readme_raw.md:61,537`).	A first-timer can spend a day trying to produce a parquet, or assume the parquet schema constrains the agent output.	One sentence in 00 §4 §2.1: participants uplo `submission.zip`; th runs `scripts/infer` and writes `[id, pre` `submission.parqu`
F20	**P2**	04 §2.1; 01 §2.1	The provided `sample_submission` contains **dummy LoRA adapters** (`adapters/main_lora`, `adapters/tool_lora`; notebook line 246). `discover_adapters()` registers every adapter and sets	Starting from the sample ships two untrained adapters: extra CUDA-graph memory, reduced KV cache, and adapters that may be applied silently. This is a self-inflicted version of the R3/R4 failures.	Add a mandatory step `adapters/` unless yo one; assert `/v1/mode` exactly one adapter (c before packaging. Add README §10 pre-sub checklist.

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			`max_loras = len(adapter_map)` (`01` §4.1).		
F21	**P2**	`03` §9.1; `04` §3.2	Adapter validation uses whatever `vllm` is installed, not the wheelhouse build the scorer uses. S23's fix may be present or absent in either.	An A/B that passes locally can be ignored on the scorer (or vice versa), wasting a slot; the whole adapter line rests on this check.	Validate with the **whee** vLLM (the same `--nc` `force-reinstall` v §1.2), record `vllm.__` and wheel hash in the and re-check the live b notes before the adap submission.
F22	**P2**	README §2; `02` §3.1	Timing is measured on 4×A100 40 GB but the scorer is 4×L4 (33–35 tok/s for 31B, S34). No derating factor appears anywhere.	The 12 h projection — the plan's single most important number — is measured on faster hardware and will be optimistic. The error is in the direction that loses the whole submission.	Measure decode tok/s stack, compute the rat tok/s, and multiply the component of p50/p95 projecting. Or use the L4x4 rehearsal (F23) a authoritative timing ch
F23	**P2**	README §4; `00` §8	"Kaggle free GPUs" are named as compute but never assigned a job. S42: quota is ~30 h/week and L4x4 consumes at 2× (S1), so a 12 h run costs ~24 h of quota — about one per week.	The only hardware that matches the scorer is effectively a once-a-week resource, and the plan does not schedule even that. Meanwhile it is the only place to measure real L4 timing and the real wheelhouse.	Assign exactly one job **12 h full-stack rehear** 3 (wheelhouse + L4 + timing) using the curre zip. Do not use Kaggle or training.
F24	**P2**	`00` §8; `03` §4.7; `07` §1.5	Licensing is asserted ("Apache 2.0 for winning code", "public training tasks have their own licenses") but never inventoried. Adapters are derivative weights of a Gemma checkpoint; the four public repos have different licenses (fastapi MIT, rich MIT, requests Apache-2.0, httpx BSD-3).	Winner disclosure requires Apache-2.0 code plus a reproducible methodology; publishing an adapter or a trajectory dataset without a license inventory is a late-stage problem you cannot fix after selection.	Add a license table to (Gemma Terms of Use weights/adapters; per- licenses for trajectory rule: publish only artifa license you can state i Keep the inventory fro
F25	**P2**	`04` §0.3; README §Status	No step to **accept the competition rules and join** before the 2026-11-25 entry deadline; no step for HF gated-model access / license acceptance for the 31B checkpoint on the remote box (`04` §3 just says "download").	Missing the entry deadline means no ranking at all; a gated download blocks week 1 silently. Both are one-line fixes that are catastrophic if skipped.	Add a day-0 checklist competition, accept ru on the submissions pa `auth login`, accept license, `huggingfac` `download` with a pinn record the revision in `env/preflight.tx`
F26	**P2**	README §5; `05` R9; `04` §9.3	The plan implies roughly weekly submissions, but queue + scoring is 14–33 h plus a pending-submission block (S30). With 39 days, a 36–48 h cadence yields ~15–20 attempts; the plan only needs 6–10.	Slots are the scarcest resource after GPU hours, and the plan leaves half of them unused while waiting for a "better" bundle.	Schedule a submissio 48 h starting day 2, ea one-line hypothesis. N slot for an unvalidated known-good bundle is submittable.
F27	**P2**	`03` §4.1; `04` §6.1	No cost estimate for trajectory generation. 129 tasks × 4 temperatures ≈ 516 runs; at ~6 min wall each that is ~52 h sequential, before failures and retries.	Week 3 is planned as "generate + filter + dataset card + smoke test" with no budget for the generation itself, and no fallback if the server is unstable.	Add the estimate and concurrency plan (8 c requests against one measure KV headroo week slips, drop to 2 t — 258 runs, still ~120 trajectories.

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F28	**P2**	06 §6; 02 §7	There is no **failure-taxonomy** experiment. The plan goes from baseline to training; 07 §1.4 lists a failure taxonomy as a paper *figure*, not as an engineering step.	Thirty failed traces classified into no-edit / wrong-file / wrong-edge-case / test-edit / loop typically yields a larger resolve gain per hour than a LoRA, and it is the input to the quality filters anyway.	Insert **E0** before T1: sa failed traces, classify, the top two classes int rules. Re-run the paire This is the highest-EV whole plan and it is cu missing.
F29	**P3**	03 §5.2 vs §5.3; 01 §4.3	Adapter size is computed as 245 MB in §5.2 (122.4 M params × 2 bytes) but quoted as "110–220 MB" in the §5.3 table and 01 §4.3.	Small, but it is the number used to decide how many adapters fit under 3 GiB and whether KV cache is at risk.	Keep one computed ta params → bytes at bf reference it from both
F30	**P3**	00 §9	"likely top几百" — untranslated text left in a score-band table.	First impression of an unpolished doc; the playbook's whole value proposition is care.	"likely top few hundred

Counts: 6 P0, 10 P1, 12 P2, 2 P3 = 30 findings.

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3. What to cut when time is short

Cut in this order; each item is independent of the baseline.

1. **Paper track** unless re-scoped by Nov 1 to weeks-1–2 evidence (F14). Highest time cost, most subjective payoff.
2. **E4B training.** Keep at most one prompt-only E4B probe (F16). Training E4B buys a bonus lane that a 0.06-bar field already occupies.
3. **FSDP2 / multi-GPU training** (F11). Single-GPU QLoRA on one card, three cards serving/parallel evals.
4. **RL, SRFT, SWE-Prime, distillation** (03 §10). None has competition evidence; all are post-SFT research bets.
5. **Graph-tool experiments** beyond one 15-task E6 run (F18).
6. **32 k sequences and rank ≥32.** Both are stretch goals with documented instability.
7. **Multi-seed evaluation** down to 2 seeds on Holdout A only (keep F13's discordant-pair floor).
8. **The 127/129 calibration** (F08). 10–15 tasks is enough to trust a comparison.
9. **Alpha sweep** down to two points, 0.5 and 1.0 (F10).
10. **Trajectory generation at 4 temperatures** down to 2 (F27).

Never cut: the day-1 probe submission (F06), the setup-time measurement (F03), the 5-min primary bundle (F02), the adapter A/B at temperature 0 (03 §9.3), the two-slot diversity rule (04 §10.4).

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4. Minimum viable path if only 10 days remain

Assume the window is **Nov 22 → Dec 2** (deadline 23:59 UTC). The paper deadline has passed; the entry deadline (Nov 25) is **day 4** — join and accept rules on day 1 or you are not ranked. Assume no adapter exists and the local evaluator is not trusted.

Rules for the 10 days: one variable per submission; never let a day pass with an empty submission queue; every bundle is reproducible from a manifest; no training unless the baseline is already scored twice.

Day	Do	Exit criterion	Do not
1 (Nov 22)	Join competition, accept rules, confirm entry before Nov 25. Submit the **unmodified public 0.24 zip** (or your best known-good	Submission accepted and queued; rules accepted; entry confirmed.	Do not wait for local eval. Do not edit the probe.

Day	Do	Exit criterion	Do not
	zip) as a probe. Start the A100 stack install in parallel.		
2	Build the harness venv from the wheelhouse; build/load `swebench-sandbox:latest`; run **one** task end-to-end.	One task produces a patch and a Phase-2 result.	Do not chase 127/129 gold patches.
3	Gold-patch check on **10 tasks** (2 fastapi, 2 rich, 2 requests, 1 httpx, 3 random); empty-patch check on the same.	≥9/10 gold pass, 0/10 empty resolves. Mark the rest uncalibrated.	Do not rebuild the environment for 2 failing tasks.
4	Run 15 tasks with the 5-min/24-call bundle and 15 with the 6-min/28-call bundle on the same tasks, alternating order. Record `agent_p50`, `setup_p50`, patch rate, first-edit call.	Projection `120 × (p50 + setup) ≤ 9.5 h` for at least one bundle.	Do not run 40 tasks; 15 paired is enough to choose a cap.
5	Score arrives. Compare to local. Apply **one** prompt rule from the failure taxonomy (30 failed traces → top class → one rule, e.g. edit by call 10). Re-run the same 15 tasks.	≥3 net wins with ≥8 discordant pairs, or revert.	Do not change cap, prompt and thinking together.
6	Package and submit the winner (bundle B). In parallel, run the E4B prompt-only probe locally on one idle GPU (same prompt, 5 min/20 calls).	Submission queued; E4B local patch rate ≥90%.	Do not train E4B.
7	Submit the E4B probe **only if** the 31B best score is ≤0.15; otherwise keep the slot for a diversity variant. Prepare the second 31B variant (thinking 512 or 6-min cap) as the hedge.	Two candidate bundles, both with local numbers.	Do not submit two near-identical zips.
8	Score check; submit the diversity variant if a slot is free. Freeze the prompt/config. Write the one-page methodology: model revision, wheelhouse hash, prompt hash, eval config, seeds, results.	Both finalists packaged and validated (`unzip -l`, size <3 GiB, one root config, one model, zero adapters).	Do not add an adapter now: training + A/B + a scored run cannot fit in 4 days.
9	Confirm both finalists are **scored**. Select both on the submissions page. Verify no pending run remains. Back up zips and manifests.	Two selected, both scored, none pending.	Do not submit anything new.
10 (Dec 2)	Buffer only. Check selection is still recorded; do not touch the submission.	Selection confirmed before 23:59 UTC.	Do not upload on the last day.

10-day cuts: no LoRA, no trajectory dataset, no adapter validation, no FSDP, no graph-tool study, no paper, no E4B training, no 40-task holdout, no multi-seed.

If day 1's probe scores ≥0.20: spend days 4–8 only on cap/thinking/prompt variants and slot diversity; skip the E4B probe entirely. **If day 1's probe fails or errors:** stop all other work until the submission mechanism and the bundle validate; a second failed probe is worse than a mediocre score. **If the queue exceeds 24 h:** assume one scored run per 2 days and pre-commit both finalists by day 7, not day 9.

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5. Arithmetic appendix (all checks reproducible)

- Deadline window: 2026-10-24 → 2026-12-02 = **39 days = 5.57 weeks**; the README's six weeks ends **2026-12-05**.

- Paper deadline is **19 days** out; entry deadline **32 days** out.
- Global budget at S34's measured mean: `120 × 5.4 min = 10.8 h`; with 1 min setup `120 × 6.4 min = 12.8 h`.
- Trajectory generation: `129 × 4 = 516` runs × ~6 min ≈ **51.6 h** sequential.
- Sign test (two-sided, exact) for a 2-win margin: d=4 → p=1.00; d=6 → 0.688; d=8 → 0.289; d=10 → 0.109; d=12 → 0.039. A 3-win margin: d=8 → 0.727; d=10 → 0.344; d=12 → 0.146.
- Adapter size: 122.4 M params × 2 bytes = **244.8 MB** (vs the 110–220 MB planning range).
- Hidden-score granularity: 1 task ≈ **0.0083**; a 2-task local win is below the 0.01 display step.